SSC MTS 2024 question paper with answers

9 October 2024 · Shift 1

78 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 12 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://ssc.gov.in/api/attachment/uploads/masterData/AnswerKeys/approved_writeup_26425.pdf

Numerical and Mathematical Ability 15 questions

Q.2

In 2016, the price of a refrigerator increased by 5%, and in 2017, it decreased by 5%. At the end of the year 2017, its price was ₹47,880. What was its price at the beginning of the year 2016?

(A) ₹54,050
(B) ₹46,000
(C) ₹48,000
(D) ₹48,560

Q.4

In a company, if 40 workers can make 50 bags in 4 days, then how many bags will 24 workers will make in 8 days?

(A) 45
(B) 60
(C) 54
(D) 40

Q.5

At a certain rate of simple interest, a sum becomes ₹9,430 in 3 years and ₹11,070 in 7 years. Find the sum.

(A) ₹8,350
(B) ₹8,200
(C) ₹7,800
(D) ₹8,000

Q.6

Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹2500 as a sum borrowed at 9% per year rate of interest for 4 years.

(A) 940
(B) 840
(C) 900
(D) 860

Q.7

A commodity is made of two metals, A and B, which cost ₹35 per kg and ₹40 per kg, respectively, in the ratio of 2 : 3. What is the cost (in ₹) of 12 kilograms of this commodity?

(A) 152
(B) 228
(C) 38
(D) 456

Q.9

A cyclist covers a distance of 2.5 km in 4 minutes 10 seconds. How long will he take to cover a distance of 6 km at the same speed?

(A) 9 minutes
(B) 11 minutes
(C) 12 minutes
(D) 10 minutes

Q.10

A person sold an article and got a loss of 9%. If he sold it for ₹51 more he would gain 8%. Find the C.P.

(A) Rs.250
(B) Rs.300
(C) Rs.350
(D) Rs.400

Q.11
The cost price of an article is 76% of its marked price. Find the gain percentage after allowing a discount of 5%.

(A) 22.5%
(B) 27.5%
(C) 24%
(D) 25%

Q.12
The average weight of a family of five members (in kg) whose weights are 40 kg, 49 kg, 56 kg, 71 kg and 39 kg is:

(A) 51
(B) 53
(C) 52
(D) 50

Q.13
A chemist prepares 100 grams of medicine by mixing two ingredients X and Y. The rate of X is ₹1,500 per 100 grams and that of Y is ₹50 per 10 grams. X and Y are mixed in such a way that the cost of the resulting medicine is ₹13 per gram. What is the quantity of X (in grams) in the medicine?

(A) 10
(B) 30
(C) 20
(D) 80

Q.14
The area of a rectangular park of length 15 m and breadth 12 m is:

(A) 144 m^2
(B) 170 m^2
(C) 54 m^2
(D) 180 m^2

Q.15
Two vendors calculate their profit percentage on the cost price and selling price, respectively. What will be the difference between the profits (in ₹) if both the vendors declare a profit of 28% on the goods sold for ₹3,200?

(A) 196
(B) 700
(C) 896
(D) 548

Q.16
The average of four girls' age is 12 years. The ages of three of them are 7, 12 and 13 years. Find the age of the fourth girl.

(A) 16 years
(B) 14 years
(C) 17 years
(D) 15 years

Q.19
Find the simple interest (in ₹) on ₹2500 as a sum borrowed at 7% per year rate of interest for 3 years.

(A) 465
(B) 565
(C) 525
(D) 485

Q.20
A car can cover 275 km in 5 hours. If its speed is reduced by 5 km/h, then how much time will the car take to cover a distance of 300 km?

(A) 5 hr
(B) 4 hr 30 min
(C) 5 hr 30 min
(D) 6 hr

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 15 questions

Q.1

What should come in place of question mark (?) in the given series based on the English alphabetical order?
AYF, FUI, KQL, PMO, ?

(A) VIQ
(B) UIR
(C) VIR
(D) UJR

Q.2

Five girls P, Q, R, S and T sit around a circular table facing towards the centre (not necessarily in the same order). Only one girl sits between S and T. P sits to the immediate left of R. P is not an immediate neighbour of S. Who sits third to the right of T?

(A) Q
(B) S
(C) R
(D) P

Q.3

What will come in place of the question mark (?) in the following equation if '+' and '–' are interchanged and '×' and '÷' are interchanged? $12 \div 3 - 8 + 16 \times 4 = ?$

(A) 44
(B) 42
(C) 40
(D) 48

Q.4

AE10 is related to CG20 in a certain way. In the same way, KO20 is related to MQ30. To which of the following is CG30 related, following the same logic?

(A) EI45
(B) GI45
(C) EF40
(D) EI40

Q.5

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series.
23, ?, 89, 177, 353, 705

(A) 47
(B) 42
(C) 49
(D) 45

Q.6

DKNF is related to YFIA in a certain way based on the English alphabetical order. In the same way, QYCR is related to LTXM. To which of the following is PEVM related, following the same logic?

(A) IYQH
(B) IYPG
(C) KZQH
(D) KZPG

Q.7

In a certain code language, 'HAVE' is coded as '2648' and 'VOLT' is coded as '3961'.What is the code for 'V' in the given code language?

(A) 6
(B) 4
(C) 3
(D) 1

Q.8

In a certain code language, 'BEST' is coded as '4982' and 'STEM' is coded as '6489'. What is the code for 'B' in that language?

(A) 4
(B) 6
(C) 8
(D) 2

Q.9

In the following number-pairs, the second number is obtained by applying certain mathematical operations to the first number. Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into their constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/ subtracting /multiplying to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.) 16, 80; 22, 110

(A) 21, 33
(B) 17, 32
(C) 15, 20
(D) 25, 125

Q.11

122 is related to 145 following a certain logic. Following the same logic, 37 is related to 50. To which of the following is 82 related, following the same logic? (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding / subtracting / multiplying, etc.. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 89
(B) 96
(C) 98
(D) 101

Q.13

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statement(s). Statements: All planets are stars. All stars are galaxies. Conclusion (I): All stars are planets. Conclusion (II): All planets are galaxies.

(A) Only conclusion II follows
(B) Both conclusions I and II follow
(C) Neither conclusion I nor II follows
(D) Only conclusion I follows

Q.14

In a certain code language, ‘nothing to hide’ is written as ‘tg mk sa’ and ‘hide and seek’ is writtenas ‘mk wd lq’. How will ‘hide’ be written in that language?

(A) lq
(B) wd
(C) mk
(D) tg

Q.15

A, B, C, P, X, Y and Z are sitting around a circular table facing the centre (but not necessarily in the same order). Y sits third to the left of A. B sits second to the left of C. Z sits to the immediate left of B. P sits third to the left of Z. A is not an immediate neighbour of C. Who sits third to the left of Y?

(A) Y
(B) X
(C) B
(D) Z

Q.17

Which two numbers should be interchanged to make the given equation correct? (24 + 14– 6) ÷ 2 + 18 × 3 – 20 = 40 (Note: Interchange should be done of entire number and not individual digits of a given number)

(A) 20 and 24
(B) 20 and 14
(C) 14 and 18
(D) 2 and 3

Q.19

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All kurtas are sarees. All sarees are blouse. Conclusions: (I) All kurtas are blouse. (II) No blouse is a saree.

(A) Neither conclusion I nor II follow
(B) Both conclusions I and II follow
(C) Only conclusion I follows
(D) Only conclusion II follows

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

Who among the following was the top run-scorer for India at the 1983 Cricket World Cup final with 38 runs?

(A) Mohinder Amarnath
(B) Kapil Dev
(C) Krishnamachari Srikkanth
(D) Sandeep Patil

Q.2

In which of the following religions was the agriculture prohibited for its followers?

(A) Jainism
(B) Buddhism
(C) Shaivism
(D) Vaishnavism

Q.3

Due to the popularity of Indian clothes in Britain, a law was passed to ban Indian clothes. Which of the following was that law?

(A) Calico Act
(B) Textile act
(C) Muslin act
(D) Calso act

Q.4

In 1974, classical singer Naina Devi was awarded the Padma Shri for her contribution to which of the following singing styles?

(A) Kajari
(B) Thumri
(C) Tappa
(D) Dadra

Q.5

According to National Multidimensional Poverty Index 2023 (A Progress Review), which state has the highest proportion of multidimensionally poor people (Headcount Ratio)?

(A) Odisha
(B) Rajasthan
(C) Bihar
(D) Jharkhand

Q.6

Amer Fort was built with red sandstone and white marble by which ruler in the 16th century?

(A) Raja Udai Singh
(B) Raja Man Singh I
(C) Raja Jai Singh
(D) Raja Amar Singh

Q.7

Who among the following is known for his/her books ‘The Algebra of Infinite Justice’, ‘Kashmir: The Case for Freedom’ and ‘Capitalism: A Ghost Story’?

(A) Amitav Ghosh
(B) Salman Rushdie
(C) Jhumpa Lahiri
(D) Arundhati Roy

Q.8
Moti Masjid in Agra fort was constructed by which of the following Mughal Emperors?

(A) Jahangir
(B) Akbar
(C) Aurangzeb
(D) Shahjahan

Q.9
The Indian Constitution has adopted the parliamentary form of Government from _____.

(A) USA
(B) France
(C) Britain
(D) Russia

Q.10
Carbon dioxide plays a vital role in changing the earth's climate, leading to a critical condition known as _____.

(A) Temperature Convection
(B) Ozone Depletion
(C) Greenhouse Effect
(D) Thermal Conduction

Q.11
What is the chemical formula for the compound commonly known as 'laughing gas'?

(A) NO_2
(B) N_2O_3
(C) N_2O
(D) NO

Q.12
Few renowned artists of _____ dance style in India are Roshan Kumari, Shovana Narayan, Maya Rao and Kumudini Lakhia.

(A) Manipuri
(B) Odissi
(C) Chhau
(D) Kathak

Q.13
To mark the 75 years of Indo-Lanka Diplomatic Relations, External Affairs Minister Jaishankar inaugurated the 'Geoffrey Bawa: It is Essential To be There' Exhibition in March 2023. Who was Geoffrey Bawa?

(A) Indian Architect
(B) Sri Lankan Poet
(C) Sri Lankan Architect
(D) Indian Poet

Q.14
'Navroz' is celebrated as the new year by which of the following communities?

(A) Buddhist
(B) Parsi
(C) Christian
(D) Sikh

Q.15
To get relief from constipation, which of the following is prescribed to be eaten in large amount?

(A) Meat
(B) Protein
(C) Fish
(D) Fibre

Q.16
Odissi Guru, _____, received the first Utkal Pratibha Samman 2023 at Bhubaneswar.

(A) Vidhya Subramanian
(B) Sailaja
(C) Ratikant Mohapatra
(D) Hema Rajagopalan

Q.17

Based on the Tendulkar committee, the National poverty line was defined as which of the following? i. ₹816 per capita per month for rural areas ii. ₹1,000 per capita per month for urban areas.

(A) Both i and ii are incorrect
(B) Only i is correct
(C) Only ii is correct
(D) Both i and ii are correct

Q.18

Which of the followings is NOT one of the government accounts of India?

(A) Contingency Fund of India
(B) General Provident Fund
(C) Public Accounts of India
(D) Consolidated Funds of India

Q.19

Which Article deals with the provisions in case of failure of the constitutional machinery in the State?

(A) Article 395
(B) Article 356
(C) Article 448
(D) Article 342

Q.20

Anorexia nervosa is an eating disorder in teenagers. Here body weight:

(A) does not change
(B) increases drastically
(C) loses drastically
(D) increases slightly

Q.21

According to average rainfall in India, the Ladakh Union Territory is located in _____.

(A) areas of low rainfall
(B) areas of medium rainfall
(C) areas of inadequate rainfall
(D) areas of high rainfall

Q.22

Where was the Intercontinental Football Cup 2023 organised?

(A) Chandigarh
(B) Jalpaiguri
(C) Dispur
(D) Bhubaneswar

Q.23

Who was the Viceroy of India when the Indian Arms Act, 1878, was passed?

(A) Lord Curzon
(B) Lord Ripon
(C) Lord Lytton
(D) Lord Dufferin

Q.24

According to Economic Survey 2023-24, which of the following states is the largest wheat producing state of India?

(A) Bihar
(B) West Bengal
(C) Uttar Pradesh
(D) Assam

Q.25

In 2023, Congress MP Shashi Tharoor has been named as the chairperson of the Parliamentary Committee on _____.

(A) Housing and Urban Affairs
(B) External Affairs
(C) Finance and Health
(D) Chemicals and Fertilisers

English Language and Comprehension 23 questions

Q.1

The following sentence has been split into four parts. Identify the part that contains a grammatical error. Jack probably/ strained his back/ as the box was/ too heavier.

(A) Jack probably
(B) as the box was
(C) too heavier.
(D) strained his back

Q.2

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined word in the given sentence. “Exclusion” of someone from a common group harms the human society.

(A) Inclination
(B) Prohibition
(C) Admission
(D) Submission

Q.3

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the underlined group of words. Because the politician's speech was “high-flown and pretentious”, it gained popularity.

(A) austere
(B) mnemonic
(C) schematising
(D) bombastic

Q.4

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Hollow

(A) Spurious
(B) Worthwhile
(C) Arched
(D) Crafty

Q.5

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Knuckle down

(A) To crush someone to the extent that they cannot get up
(B) To start working or studying hard
(C) To engage in street fighting
(D) To make others do their share of hard work using power

Q.6

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. My son, who is a cricketer too, is a M.A. from Delhi University.

(A) My son, who is
(B) a cricketer too
(C) from Delhi University
(D) is a M.A.

Q.7

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined word. There are so many “flies” on the food.

(A) Various types of bacteria
(B) To move from one place to another
(C) Insects with wings
(D) To hover up in the sky

Q.8

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A person who eats too much

(A) Sycophant
(B) Fatalist
(C) Misogamist
(D) Glutton

Q.9

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Miscellaneous
(B) Mediterranean
(C) Peculliar
(D) Parallel

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Personally, Ramesh was _____ to his villagers than his elder brother.

(A) most helpful
(B) more helpful
(C) helpfuller
(D) helped

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks. Kiara was born in India but she went to _____ university in _____ United Kingdom.

(A) a; No article required
(B) a; the
(C) the; No article required
(D) No article required; the

Q.13

Select the most appropriate synonym of the word 'Plain' from the given sentence. Mr. Das believes and follows the principle of simple living and high thinking.

(A) principle
(B) High
(C) believes
(D) Simple

Q.14

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Inanimate

(A) Cartoon
(B) Imitate
(C) Lifeless
(D) Inhumane

Q.15

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. As technology evolves, consumers increasingly _____ products with enhanced features and greater efficiency.

(A) has demanded
(B) were demanding
(C) demand
(D) might demand

Q.16

The given sentence is divided into four segments. Select the option that has the segment with a grammatical error. She forbade / him not / to enter that / room.

(A) to enter that
(B) room.
(C) she forbade
(D) him not

Q.18

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. The gift of the gab

(A) Just at the last moment
(B) The ability to speak easily and confidently
(C) Impossible
(D) Life full of quarrels

Q.19

Select the most appropriate idiom that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. The comedian's jokes were so funny that the audience was "laughing uncontrollably".

(A) as easy as pie
(B) in stitches
(C) in bits and pieces
(D) on the ball

Q.20

Select the option that can be used as one-word substitute for the given group of words. One who performs daring gymnastic feats

(A) Advocate
(B) Acrobat
(C) Adonis
(D) Addict

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The standard of living of any country means the average (1)_____ share of the goods and services which the country produces. A country's standard of living, therefore, (2)_____ first and foremost on its capacity to produce wealth. 'Wealth', in this sense, is not money, for we do not live (3)_____ money but on things that money (4)_____ buy; 'goods' such as food and clothing and 'services' such as transport and entertainment. A country's capacity to produce wealth depends upon many factors, most of which have an effect on one another. Wealth depends to a great extent (5)_____ a country's natural resources, such as coal, gold and other minerals, water supply and so on.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 1.

(A) person
(B) per son
(C) person's
(D) persons'

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The standard of living of any country means the average (1)_____ share of the goods and services which the country produces. A country's standard of living, therefore, (2)_____ first and foremost on its capacity to produce wealth. 'Wealth', in this sense, is not money, for we do not live (3)_____ money but on things that money (4)_____ buy; 'goods' such as food and clothing and 'services' such as transport and entertainment. A country's capacity to produce wealth depends upon many factors, most of which have an effect on one another. Wealth depends to a great extent (5)_____ a country's natural resources, such as coal, gold and other minerals, water supply and so on.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 2.

(A) dependent
(B) depended
(C) depending
(D) depends

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The standard of living of any country means the average (1)_____ share of the goods and services which the country produces. A country's standard of living, therefore, (2)_____ first and foremost on its capacity to produce wealth. 'Wealth', in this sense, is not money, for we do not live (3)_____ money but on things that money (4)_____ buy; 'goods' such as food and clothing and 'services' such as transport and entertainment. A country's capacity to produce wealth depends upon many factors, most of which have an effect on one another. Wealth depends to a great extent (5)_____ a country's natural resources, such as coal, gold and other minerals, water supply and so on.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 3.

(A) into
(B) by
(C) in
(D) on

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The standard of living of any country means the average (1)_____ share of the goods and services which the country produces. A country's standard of living, therefore, (2)_____ first and foremost on its capacity to produce wealth. 'Wealth', in this sense, is not money, for we do not live (3)_____ money but on things that money (4)_____ buy; 'goods' such as food and clothing and 'services' such as transport and entertainment. A country's capacity to produce wealth depends upon many factors, most of which have an effect on one another. Wealth depends to a great extent (5)_____ a country's natural resources, such as coal, gold and other minerals, water supply and so on.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 4.

(A) should
(B) must
(C) ought
(D) can

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. The standard of living of any country means the average (1)_____ share of the goods and services which the country produces. A country's standard of living, therefore, (2)_____ first and foremost on its capacity to produce wealth. 'Wealth', in this sense, is not money, for we do not live (3)_____ money but on things that money (4)_____ buy; 'goods' such as food and clothing and 'services' such as transport and entertainment. A country's capacity to produce wealth depends upon many factors, most of which have an effect on one another. Wealth depends to a great extent (5)_____ a country's natural resources, such as coal, gold and other minerals, water supply and so on.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 5.

(A) over
(B) in
(C) upon
(D) with

Answer key

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.2 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**	Q.7 **(D)**	Q.9 **(D)**
Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**
Q.16 **(A)**	Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(D)**			

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(C)**
Q.15 **(B)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.19 **(C)**			

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(D)**
Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(B)**
Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(C)**	

Explanations

Numerical and Mathematical Ability

Q.2 · Answer (C) ₹48,000

The two changes multiply the price by 1.05 × 0.95 = 0.9975, so the price at the start of 2016 was 47,880 ÷ 0.9975 = ₹48,000.

Q.4 · Answer (B) 60

40 workers × 4 days = 160 worker-days make 50 bags. 24 workers × 8 days = 192 worker-days make 50 × 192/160 = 60 bags.

Q.5 · Answer (B) ₹8,200

The 4 years from year 3 to year 7 add ₹11,070 − ₹9,430 = ₹1,640 of interest, ₹410 a year. The sum is ₹9,430 − 3 × ₹410 = ₹8,200.

Q.6 · Answer (C) 900

SI = 2500 × 9 × 4/100 = ₹900.

Q.7 · Answer (D) 456

In the ratio 2 : 3 the commodity costs (2 × 35 + 3 × 40)/5 = ₹38 a kg, so 12 kg cost 12 × 38 = ₹456.

Q.9 · Answer (D) 10 minutes

4 minutes 10 seconds is 250 seconds for 2.5 km, or 100 seconds a km. 6 km take 600 seconds: 10 minutes.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Rs.300

From a 9% loss to an 8% gain is 17% of the cost price, which is ₹51. C.P. = 51 × 100/17 = ₹300.

Q.11 · Answer (D) 25%

Take the marked price as 100: C.P. = 76 and S.P. = 95 after the 5% discount. Gain = 19/76 × 100 = 25%.

Q.12 · Answer (A) 51

(40 + 49 + 56 + 71 + 39)/5 = 255/5 = 51 kg.

Q.13 · Answer (D) 80

X costs ₹15 a gram and Y ₹5 a gram. With x grams of X: 15x + 5(100 − x) = 13 × 100, so 10x = 800 and x = 80.

Q.14 · Answer (D) 180 m²

Area = length × breadth = 15 × 12 = 180 m².

Q.15 · Answer (A) 196

On cost price: ₹3,200 = 1.28 × C.P., so C.P. = ₹2,500 and the profit is ₹700. On selling price: 28% of ₹3,200 = ₹896. Difference = 896 − 700 = ₹196.

Q.16 · Answer (A) 16 years

The four ages total 4 × 12 = 48 years, so the fourth girl is 48 − (7 + 12 + 13) = 16 years old.

Q.19 · Answer (C) 525

SI = 2500 × 7 × 3/100 = ₹525.

Q.20 · Answer (D) 6 hr

The car's speed is 275 ÷ 5 = 55 km/h; 5 km/h less is 50 km/h, and 300 km then take 300 ÷ 50 = 6 hours.

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.1 · Answer (B) UIR

First letters move 5 forward (A, F, K, P, U), second letters 4 back (Y, U, Q, M, I) and third letters 3 forward (F, I, L, O, R): UIR.

Q.2 · Answer (B) S
Facing the centre, a girl's left is the next seat clockwise. P sits just left of R and S is not next to P, so with one girl between S and T the seats run clockwise R, P, T, Q, S. Three places to T's right (anticlockwise) are P, R and then S.

Q.3 · Answer (C) 40
After interchanging the signs: 12 × 3 + 8 – 16 ÷ 4 = 36 + 8 – 4 = 40.

Q.4 · Answer (D) EI40
Each letter moves 2 places forward and the number rises by 10: AE10 → CG20 and KO20 → MQ30. So CG30 → EI40.

Q.5 · Answer (D) 45
Each term is twice the one before minus 1: 89 × 2 – 1 = 177 and 177 × 2 – 1 = 353. So the missing term is 23 × 2 – 1 = 45, and 45 × 2 – 1 = 89.

Q.6 · Answer (C) KZQH
Each letter moves 5 places back, wrapping round from A to Z: D → Y, K → F, N → I, F → A. So P → K, E → Z, V → Q, M → H: KZQH.

Q.7 · Answer (A) 6
V is the only letter in both words and 6 the only digit in both codes, so V = 6.

Q.8 · Answer (D) 2
S, T and E are in both words, as are 4, 8 and 9 in both codes. The letter left in BEST is B and the digit left in its code is 2, so B = 2.

Q.9 · Answer (D) 25, 125
In each pair the second number is five times the first: 16 × 5 = 80 and 22 × 5 = 110. Likewise 25 × 5 = 125.

Q.11 · Answer (D) 101
Each number is $n^2 + 1$ and goes with $(n + 1)^2 + 1$: $122 = 11^2 + 1 \rightarrow 12^2 + 1 = 145$ and $37 = 6^2 + 1 \rightarrow 7^2 + 1 = 50$. So $82 = 9^2 + 1 \rightarrow 10^2 + 1 = 101$.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Only conclusion II follows
All planets are stars and all stars are galaxies, so all planets are galaxies (II). That all planets are stars does not make all stars planets, so I does not follow.

Q.14 · Answer (C) mk
'hide' is the only word in both sentences and 'mk' the only code in both, so hide = mk.

Q.15 · Answer (B) X
Facing the centre, a person's left is the next seat clockwise. Clockwise from C come a seat, B, Z, two seats and P. Y three seats left of A, with A not next to C, puts Y between C and B and A just before P: C, Y, B, Z, X, A, P. Third to the left of Y is X.

Q.17 · Answer (C) 14 and 18
Interchanging 14 and 18: (24 + 18 – 6) ÷ 2 + 14 × 3 – 20 = 18 + 42 – 20 = 40.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Only conclusion I follows
All kurtas are sarees and all sarees are blouse, so all kurtas are blouse (I). As every saree is a blouse, some blouse are sarees, so II is false.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Krishnamachari Srikkanth
Krishnamachari Srikkanth top-scored for India in the 1983 World Cup final with 38 of their 183 runs; India beat the West Indies by 43 runs.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Jainism
Jainism's strict non-violence rules out harming even insects and worms, which ploughing does, so its followers kept away from agriculture and took mainly to trade.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Calico Act
Worried by the popularity of Indian printed cottons, the British government passed the Calico Act in 1720, banning the use of printed cotton textiles (chintz) in England.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Thumri
Naina Devi (Nilina Sen) was one of the best-known thumri singers of Hindustani music.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Bihar
NITI Aayog's National Multidimensional Poverty Index 2023 found Bihar with the highest share of multidimensionally poor people, about a third of its population in 2019-21.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Raja Man Singh I
Amer Fort near Jaipur was built by Raja Man Singh I, Akbar's general, from the late 16th century.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Arundhati Roy
'The Algebra of Infinite Justice' and 'Capitalism: A Ghost Story' are essay collections by Arundhati Roy, the author of 'The God of Small Things', who is also one of the contributors to 'Kashmir: The Case for Freedom'.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Shahjahan
The white-marble Moti Masjid inside Agra Fort was built by Shah Jahan.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Britain
The parliamentary form of government, with a cabinet answerable to the legislature, was borrowed from Britain.

Q.10 · Answer (C) Greenhouse Effect
Carbon dioxide is a greenhouse gas: it traps heat given off by the earth, so a rising level of it strengthens the greenhouse effect and warms the climate.

Q.11 · Answer (C) N_2O
Laughing gas is nitrous oxide, N_2O.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Kathak
Roshan Kumari, Shovana Narayan, Maya Rao and Kumudini Lakhia are all noted Kathak dancers.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Sri Lankan Architect
Geoffrey Bawa (1919-2003) was a Sri Lankan architect, a pioneer of the style known as tropical modernism.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Parsi
Navroz, the Persian new year, is celebrated in India by the Parsi community.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Fibre
Dietary fibre (roughage) adds bulk to the stool and helps it pass, relieving constipation.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Ratikant Mohapatra
SSC's key gives Ratikant Mohapatra, an Odissi guru and the son of the Odissi maestro Kelucharan Mohapatra.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Both i and ii are correct
Using the Tendulkar committee's method, the Planning Commission set the 2011-12 poverty line at ₹816 per capita per month in rural areas and ₹1,000 in urban areas.

Q.18 · Answer (B) General Provident Fund
The government's accounts are the Consolidated Fund of India, the Contingency Fund of India and the Public Account of India. The General Provident Fund is a savings scheme whose deposits are held in the Public Account, not an account of its own.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Article 356
Article 356 provides for President's Rule in a State where the constitutional machinery has failed.

Q.20 · Answer (C) loses drastically
In anorexia nervosa a person eats too little out of an intense fear of gaining weight, and body weight falls drastically.

Q.21 · Answer (C) areas of inadequate rainfall
Ladakh, a cold desert in the rain shadow of the Himalayas, gets far less than 50 cm of rain a year, which puts it among the areas of inadequate rainfall.

Q.22 · Answer (D) Bhubaneswar
The 2023 Intercontinental Cup was played at the Kalinga Stadium, Bhubaneswar, in June 2023; India won it.

Q.23 · Answer (C) Lord Lytton
The Arms Act of 1878, which barred Indians from keeping arms without a licence, was passed under Lord Lytton (Viceroy 1876-80), as was the Vernacular Press Act.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Uttar Pradesh
Uttar Pradesh is India's largest wheat producer, ahead of Madhya Pradesh and Punjab.

Q.25 · Answer (D) Chemicals and Fertilisers
SSC's key gives Chemicals and Fertilisers: Shashi Tharoor chaired the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Chemicals and Fertilisers in 2023, having been moved to it from the Committee on Information Technology (reported in October 2022). He took over the External Affairs committee in 2024.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (C) too heavier.
'Too' takes the positive degree: 'the box was too heavy', not 'too heavier'.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Prohibition
'Exclusion' is keeping someone out: 'prohibition', barring them, is the closest. 'Admission' is its opposite.

Q.3 · Answer (D) bombastic
'Bombastic' describes speech or writing that is high-flown and pretentious.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Worthwhile
'Hollow' in its figurative sense means without real worth (a hollow promise); its opposite is 'worthwhile'.

Q.5 · Answer (B) To start working or studying hard
To 'knuckle down' is to start working or studying hard.

Q.6 · Answer (D) is a M.A.
'M.A.' begins with a vowel sound ('em'), so it takes 'an': 'is an M.A.'

Q.7 · Answer (C) Insects with wings
Here 'flies' is the plural noun, the winged insects, not the verb 'to fly'.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Glutton
A glutton is a person who eats too much. A sycophant flatters, a fatalist accepts fate and a misogamist hates marriage.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Peculliar
The correct spelling is 'peculiar'.

Q.10 · Answer (B) more helpful
'Than' calls for the comparative: 'more helpful'. 'Helpfuller' is not standard.

Q.12 · Answer (B) a; the
'University' begins with a 'yoo' sound, so 'a university'; a country name with 'Kingdom' takes 'the': 'the United Kingdom'.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Simple
'Simple living' is plain living, without luxury: 'simple' means 'plain'.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Lifeless
'Inanimate' means not alive: 'lifeless'.

Q.15 · Answer (C) demand
A general, ongoing truth alongside the present 'evolves' takes the simple present, and the plural 'consumers' takes 'demand'.

Q.16 · Answer (D) him not
'Forbid' already carries the negative, so 'not' is wrong: 'She forbade him to enter that room.'

Q.18 · Answer (B) The ability to speak easily and confidently
'The gift of the gab' is the ability to speak easily and confidently.

Q.19 · Answer (B) in stitches
To be 'in stitches' is to laugh uncontrollably.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Acrobat
An acrobat performs daring gymnastic feats. An Adonis is a very handsome young man.

Q.21 · Answer (C) person's
'The average person's share': the singular possessive, one typical person's share of what the country produces.

Q.22 · Answer (D) depends
The subject, 'A country's standard of living', is singular and the passage is in the simple present: 'depends' on.

Q.23 · Answer (D) on
To 'live on' something is to depend on it for a living: we live on the things money buys, not on money itself.

Q.24 · Answer (D) can
'Can' expresses ability: the things that money is able to buy.

Q.25 · Answer (C) upon
'Depend' takes 'upon' (or 'on'): 'depends to a great extent upon a country's natural resources'.

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